

VIOLET BIRD'S-NEST ORCHID*Limodorum abortivum*
F: OrchidaceaeThis S. European orchid lacks green leaves. For food, it depends entirely on *Russula* fungi living in its roots.80 cm
32 in**TONGUE ORCHID***Serapias lingua*
F: Orchidaceae

The lip of this unusual Mediterranean orchid's flower hangs down like a tongue, acting as a landing platform for visiting insects.

30 cm
12 inthree sepals
and two petals
on each flower**DENDROBIUM SP.**

F: Orchidaceae

Including over 1,000 species of diverse shapes, colours, and sizes, this genus of epiphytic orchids is found from S.E. Asia to New Zealand.

2 m
6½ ft90 cm
35 in**LIZARD ORCHID***Himantoglossum hircinum*
F: Orchidaceae

The long lips of this orchid from southern Europe have a fanciful resemblance to tiny lizards, hence its common name.

15 m
50 ft

SEED POD

LEATHERY
EVERGREEN LEAVES**FLAT-LEAVED VANILLA ORCHID***Vanilla planifolia*
F: Orchidaceae

Native to Mexico and C. America, this climbing orchid is the source of the flavouring vanilla.

ROTHCHILD'S VANDA*Vanda 'Rothschildiana'*
F: OrchidaceaeThis cultivated hybrid was created by crossing species of the genus *Vanda*, which are tree-living orchids native to tropical Asia.60 cm
23½ in**AUTUMN LADY'S-TRESSES***Spiranthes spiralis*
F: Orchidaceae

This small, mainly grassland orchid from temperate Eurasia is notable for its flowers being arranged spirally up the flower stalk.

20 cm
8 in**NUN'S ORCHID***Phaius tankervilleae*
F: Orchidaceae

This fragrant ground-living orchid is widely cultivated. Its native range is tropical and subtropical S.E. Asia and the South Pacific.

1 m
3¼ ft**LIPPEROSE MOTH ORCHID***Phalaenopsis 'Lipperose'*
F: OrchidaceaeThis cultivated hybrid is one of many developed using the genus *Phalaenopsis* from S.E. Asia with its broad, flattened flowers.1 m
3¼ ft60 cm
23½ indrooping
sepals30 cm
12 in**MILITARY ORCHID***Orchis militaris*
F: Orchidaceae

This chalk-loving Eurasian orchid may have acquired its name because the individual flowers resemble helmeted human figures.

COMMON DONKEY ORCHID*Diuris corymbosa*
F: Orchidaceae

Native to S.E. and S.W. Australia, this orchid gets its common name from the shape of its side petals, which resemble donkeys' ears.

BEARDED GREENHOOD ORCHID*Pterostylis* sp.
F: Orchidaceae

Scent from these ground-living Australian orchids attracts small male flies. A feathery trap then spurs the fly to collect the pollen sacs.

flower resembles
a fat bumblebeesepal and petals form
protective hood over
inner flowerflower trigger
snaps shut to
trap insect40 cm
16 inlower sepals
provide landing
stage for insects50 cm
20 in**BEE ORCHID***Ophrys apifera*
F: Orchidaceae

Although in a genus whose flowers attract pollinating male insects by mimicking females, this Eurasian orchid in practice often pollinates itself.

DARK-RED HELLEBORINE*Epipactis atrorubens*
F: Orchidaceae

The long roots of this fragrant Eurasian orchid help it grow successfully even within the cracks of limestone cliffs.

60 cm
23½ inlanceolate
leaves on
each stalkflower attracts
pollinating
insects